After back-to-back successful dry runs, Sivarasan looked for the right opportunity for the assassination—it was a task he was determined to accomplish at any cost. But time was running out. On the morning of 19 May, newspapers reported that a political rally by Rajiv Gandhi was to be held in Sriperumbudur on 21 May. Sivarasan told Murugan this was their chance.

The interrogation team decided to split again. Kanth and Raju sat with Bhagyanathan and Peraribalan. Verma and Ragothaman sat with Murugan and Nalini. Sri Kumar and Manoharan sat with Padma and Ravi Shankar.

Murugan talked about how Sriperumbudur was finalized as the venue. There wouldn't be another opportunity to strike at Rajiv Gandhi after that. Sivarasan made it clear that failure was unacceptable in the LTTE, to which the human bombs said they could not wait any longer to kill Rajiv Gandhi.

On the morning of 21 May, Ravi Shankar called Haribabu and asked him to buy a sandalwood garland and meet Sivarasan and the others at Nalini's new house in Lawyer's Colony, Villivakkam. A sheepish Haribabu told him that his camera was not working properly and asked if Shankar could lend him one. The latter told the interrogators that he didn't want to give one of his own cameras, since they were expensive, so he borrowed a cheaper model from a friend and gave it to Haribabu, along with a Kodak colour roll.

The interrogators deduced from the confessions of Murugan, Nalini, Bhagyanathan and Ravi Shankar that the night before the assassination was a relaxed one for everyone as they watched a film on VHS. There was no sign of tension or nervousness in Dhanu when Shubha, the substitute human bomb, helped her wear the denim vest with the bomb. Dhanu also wore a pair of spectacles for disguise. All was well and nobody noticed Dhanu quietly slip out—she went to the roof of the house.

Nalini said after a while, when there was still no sign of Dhanu, she and Shubha went looking for her and found Dhanu looking up at the sky and the stars in it. Dhanu was mumbling to her 'martyred colleagues' that she would soon join them, after she had taken revenge. Dhanu expressed her gratitude to Prabhakaran more than once for this opportunity to exact